

Château Mouton Rothschild 2015

CSPC# 749529

750mlx6

13.2% alc./vol.

CSPC# 831586

750mlx6

13.2% alc./vol.

Grape Variety

82% Cabernet Sauvignon, 16% Merlot, 2% Cabernet Franc.

Appellation

Pauillac

Classification

First Growth. Premier Grand Cru Classe in 1855 & in 1973

Website

<http://www.chateau-mouton-rothschild.com/>

General Info

Château Mouton Rothschild, owned by Baroness Philippine de Rothschild and her children, is regarded as one of the world's greatest wines. The story of Mouton Rothschild is that of a magical combination of soil, climate and devotion of one man, Baron Philippe de Rothschild (1902-1988), Baroness Philippine's father. In 1853, Baron Nathaniel de Rothschild, from the English branch of the family, bought Château Brane-Mouton and immediately renamed it in Mouton Rothschild. Baron Philippe de Rothschild, when he took over the estate in 1922, decided to devote his life to it and to make Mouton unique, producing the very best wine. In 1924, he was the first to introduce entire chateau bottling. In 1926, he built the majestic 100-metre barrel hall. In 1945, to celebrate the liberation of France, he had the idea of crowning the label of that year's vintage with a V for Victory. Since then, a different label is created for each vintage by famous painters. In 1962, he opened the Museum of Wine in Art. In 1973, he obtained the revision of the 1855 classification so that Mouton would be officially recognized as a First Growth.

Vintage

Although 2015 was slightly warmer than average, it was above all very dry (706 mm of rain, compared with an annual average of 862 mm), especially between February and July, from budbreak to veraison. As a result, the berries remained small, which explains why the yield was rather low even though we had hopes of a normal crop after flowering.

Higher-than-average rainfall in August and September helped to prevent the ripening process from coming to a halt in a vineyard already stressed by the lack of water.

Consequently, the grapes matured at rather different rates from one parcel to another, according to the terroir, the grape variety and the age of the vines.

In order to ensure that each variety and each parcel was picked at optimum maturity, the harvest period was the longest in living memory.

The grapes were magnificent, and fermentation took place quickly. The wines immediately showed plenty of colour and a complete array of very intense aromas ranging from red and black fruit to spice and incense.

The tannins are generally very well-rounded, dense and seamlessly smooth. After blending, the wines still have the same aromatic intensity and complex, full-bodied structures which barrel-maturing should further enhance.

Our 2015 vintage in Pauillac is very similar in its heft and opulence to the 2005 vintage.

Vineyards

The Mouton vineyards incorporate 75 hectares of typical gravelly soil over a base of sand, clay, marl and limestone. They are situated on a mound or *motte* at an altitude of approximately 40 metres, dizzying heights for the flat and undulating land of the Medoc. It is widely thought that *motte* is the origin of the name Mouton, the local Bordeaux dialect providing us with as many words for mound, hill or hillock as there are perhaps fish in the *Gironde*. It does not derive, as some rather unkind individuals have postulated (I say unkind because the accusation brings rural, rustic tones), from the French for sheep, *mouton*, although this might be suggested by the grazing pasture that abuts the estate. The vines are 80% Cabernet Sauvignon, 10% Cabernet Franc, 8% Merlot, 2% Petit Verdot, planted at a density of 8500 hectares, with an admirable average age of around 50 years.

Harvest

14 September to 2 October 2015

Maturation

Once harvested, fermentation is in 225-hectolitre vats of wood, with a maceration of 15 to 25 days. Then comes up to 22 months in oak before bottling.



Tasting Notes The wine has an attractive, deep, and dark colour with a purple tint. The refined and elegant nose reveals fruity wild blackberry and bilberry aromas. Notes of toast, liquorice and blond tobacco then emerge to fill out a rich and complex range of aromas. The fresh, full-bodied, and slightly saline attack shows great intensity, opening on smooth and creamy tannins which enfold a silky texture lifted by a touch of minerality. The impression on the palate is very full, rich in ripe fruit and peppery spice flavours. An exceptionally long finish concludes a remarkably balanced wine.

Cellaring Drink 2025-2045

Scores/Awards **96 points** - James Molesworth, Wine Spectator - March 31, 2018
98 points - Lisa Perrotti-Brown, Wine Advocate Interim Issue - February 2018
98 points - Neal Martin, Wine Journal - March 2018
99 points - James Suckling, JamesSuckling.com - February 2018
98 points - Roger Voss, Wine Enthusiast - April 2018
19 points - Jancis Robinson, JancisRobinson.com - April 2016
98 points - Stephen Spurrier, Decanter.com - April 2016
98 points - Jane Anson, Decanter.com - November 2017
94 points - Tim Atkin, MW - timatkin.com - April 2016
19+ points - Farr Vintner - March 2016
96 points - Jeannie Cho Lee MW, asianpalate.com - May 2016
97+ points - Antonio Galloni, Vinous - February 2018
99 points - Jeb Dunnuck MW - February 2018
18.5+ points - Matthew Jukes, MW - April 2016
19 points - La Revue du Vin France - June 2016
19 points - Bettane & Desseauve - April 2016
19 points - Gault & Millau - June 2016
